Magnetic Compass



Category: **Measuring & Marking Tools** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 6 labs

Covers these lab items: Compass; Compasses

What it is used for

A magnetic compass indicates direction by aligning with Earth's magnetic field. Use it for basic navigation and direction marking away from magnetic interference.

How to use

1. Place the compass on a level surface or hold it horizontally.
2. Move away from magnets, steel objects, electrical equipment, and vehicles.
3. Allow the needle to settle before reading the direction.
4. Rotate the compass housing or align the direction mark as required.
5. Read the indicated direction and compare it with the map if needed.
6. Store the compass safely after use.

⚠ Safety

- Keep the compass away from strong magnets and magnetic objects for reliable readings.
- Do not use a damaged compass or one with a stuck needle.
- Use a map and other navigation aids when direction is critical.

Care & storage

- Keep the compass dry, clean, and protected from impact and magnetic interference.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.